

Adams. But his turn for the White House came after the 1828 election, which he won on the Democratic ticket.

Like many frontier men, Jackson resented the dominance of the East. He was the first president to translate his national appeal into a vision of a strong executive that defended the people against abuse by both local and state governments and private interests. In this he was opposed by the Whig Party, dominated by a redoubtable trio, the “Great Triumvirate,” comprising Senators John C. Calhoun of South Carolina, Henry Clay of Kentucky, and Daniel Webster of Massachusetts. The Whigs firmly asserted the supremacy of Congress over the president. Jackson easily won a second term in 1832, growing in his conviction that the president represented the popular will. His belief was displayed in a series of crises, triggered by the inconsistent ways that the sections of the nation responded to the rival claims of federal power and states’ rights. Southern states had long coveted Indian lands east of the Mississippi. Although federal treaties and the U.S. Supreme Court denied these states the right to steal Indian territory, Jackson chose to support the state of Georgia’s right to seize Indian land. He sent in the army to ensure the removal of Cherokee and other tribes that resisted. Thousands died on this “Trail of Tears” as the refugees trekked west.

Andrew Jackson's supporters came from every state for his inaugural celebration in 1829, horrifying many by surging into the White House and climbing onto tables until bowls of punch were carried onto the lawn.